



PIRATE ACADEMY

Cyber Seas of Knowledge

Our Children Online in the Age of AI

A guide for parents, grandparents and educators on the risks of **sharenting**



What is sharenting? It's when parents, grandparents, relatives or schools post photos, stories or details about a child online **without the child's permission**.

Every post adds to a child's **digital footprint**, one that may follow them for life and that they never chose. With the rise of **AI slop** (fake, low-quality content made with artificial intelligence), our children's photos have become easy to copy, alter and fake.

Inside this guide:

Why it's riskier now

At school

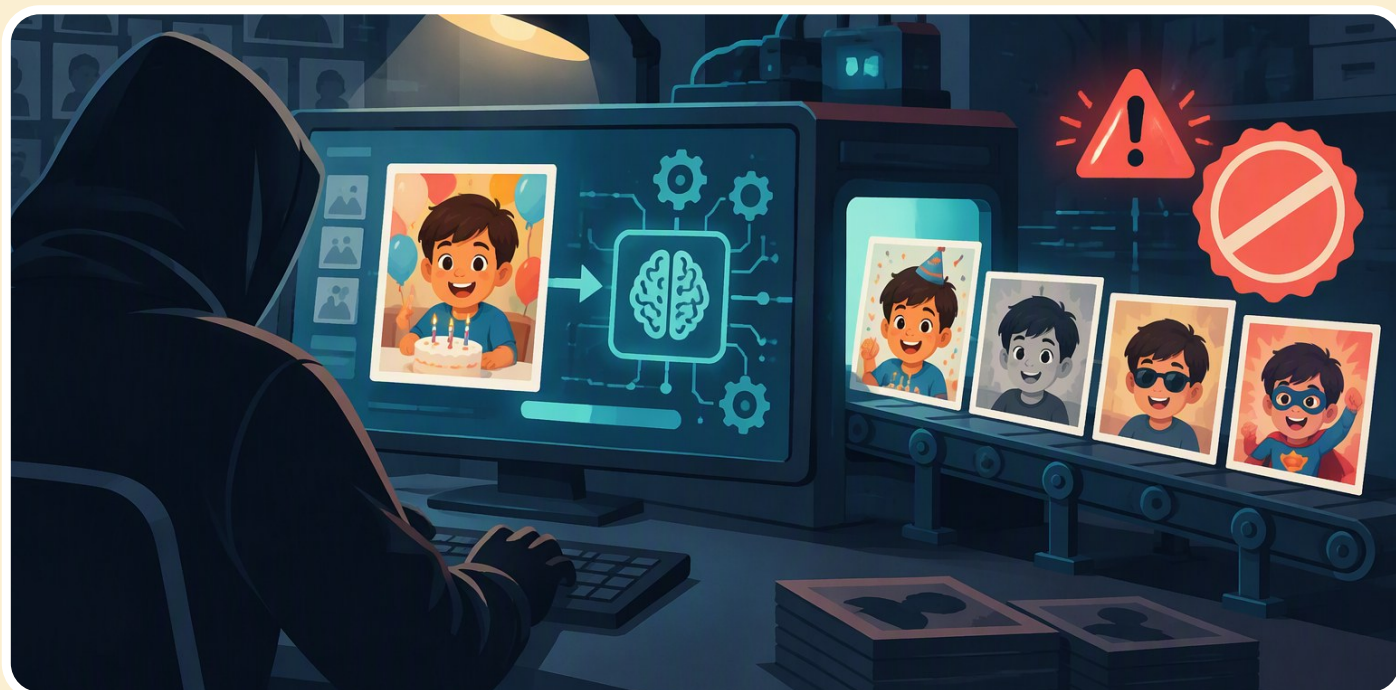
Grandparents & family

Our family plan



Why is posting **riskier now?**

A photo used to stay in the family album. Today, anyone can copy your child's picture, change it with AI in seconds, and share it in places you'd never imagine.



1 Deepfakes

Innocent photos of children turned into fake, harmful images or videos that are hard to tell from real ones.

2 AI slop

Your child's face reused in fake accounts, adverts and viral posts to farm likes or scam people.

3 Identity theft

A full name, birthday and school name are enough to impersonate a child in the future.

4 Location & routine

Uniforms, street signs and hidden location data (GPS) in photos can show strangers where a child is.

5 A permanent footprint

What's posted today may embarrass a child or be used to bully them years from now.

6 Automated scraping

Public photos may be collected and used to train AI systems without your knowledge or consent.

Remember: nothing posted online is ever fully deleted. Even after you remove it, copies or screenshots may remain.



School sharenting

Schools and kindergartens share photos of concerts, activities and graduations, and parents film whole stages full of other people's children. The intentions are good, but one video can reveal many children's names, school and location all at once.



For schools & teachers

- Get clear written consent from parents before posting any photo, with the right to say no or withdraw it later.
- Photograph hands, artwork and activities instead of faces.
- Never combine a child's full name, photo and school name in one post.
- Use closed, secure platforms to share with parents instead of public pages.
- Remove location data from photos before sharing.

For parents at school events

- Don't post photos of other people's children without their parents' permission.
- Check the background: school name, uniform, classroom signs.
- Don't reshare class-group photos outside the group.
- Ask the school about its photo and posting policy.
- Film your own child, avoid crowd shots, and sometimes just put the phone down and enjoy the moment.

A question for every educator: would this child be happy to see this photo when they turn 18?



Grandparents & relatives: **love with awareness**

Grandparents, aunts, uncles and cousins love and celebrate our children. But one proud tap on "forward" can send a photo to dozens of group chats in seconds, far beyond the family. Some relatives also upload photos to AI apps that turn children into cartoons or "enhanced" pictures, sharing them with companies whose use of them we can't control.



Tips for the wider family

- Family WhatsApp groups aren't always private; a photo can be forwarded in one tap.
- Ask the parents before uploading a child's photo to any AI app.
- Send photos directly to close family instead of posting them publicly.
- Never post bath-time, bedtime, crying or embarrassing moments.
- Respect the parents' decision, even if it differs from your habits.

How to talk to grandparents kindly

"We love how proud you are of your grandchild, and we want to protect them together. Could we keep their photos in our family group, and check with each other before forwarding them or changing them with AI?"

Respect and awareness together:

honouring our elders doesn't conflict with protecting our little ones. A calm, loving conversation turns grandparents into partners in protection.



Before you post... pause and ask



1 Have I asked my child? (if they're old enough)

☐

2 Could this photo embarrass them in 10 years?

☐

3 Does it reveal their location, school or daily routine?

☐

4 Who can actually see this post?

☐

5 Could it be misused or altered with AI?

☐

If you hesitate to answer... don't post.

How to talk to children at each age

Ages 3 to 6

Teach them they can say "no photo, please", and that their say over their body and pictures matters.

Ages 7 to 12

Ask their permission before posting, and explain the digital footprint in simple words.

Ages 13 and up

Agree on family posting rules together, and be the role model.

"Each of you is a shepherd, and each of you is responsible for his flock."

Agreed upon (Bukhari & Muslim)

Our children's privacy is a trust (amanah). Share this guide with your family and your school.